

Glossary

ALDERMAN A senior official in a local council

ARCHERY A very popular sport in the Elizabethan era. It involves using a bow to shoot an arrow at a target.

ARMADA A fleet of ships sent by Philip II of Spain to invade England in 1588

BLOODSPORT Public entertainment during the Elizabethan era in which crowds watched cruel fights between dogs, bears, and other animals—often to the death and for money

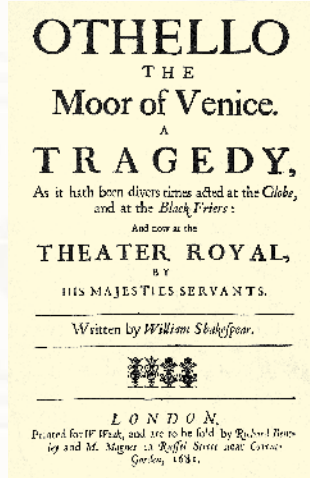
CATHOLIC A branch of Christianity that descends from the original church before the division with Protestantism occurred

CONEYCATCHERS Professional cheats who made money from gambling. Coney was a slang term for “rabbit” and these cheats called their victims “coneyes”.

COURT The residence of the monarch, in which the king or queen presided over affairs of the state and also received visitors and enjoyed entertainment

CRUCIFIX A cross or image of a cross showing the image of Jesus Christ nailed to it. A crucifix represents Christ's crucifixion, in which he was nailed to an upright wooden cross and left to die.

DUEL A prearranged and supervised fight with weapons between two individuals as a means of settling a dispute



First Folio

EXECUTION The killing of a criminal proven guilty by the state. One common method of execution during the Elizabethan era was to be hanged on the gallows.

FIRST FOLIO The first edition of Shakespeare's collected works, which was published in 1623 and contained 36 plays

FOLIO A sheet of paper folded in half to make four pages for a book; also a book made of such sheets

GALLANT A fashionably dressed gentleman

GALLOWS A wooden structure with a horizontal beam that holds a rope for hanging criminals

HORNBOOK A page with text held in a frame with a thin window of flattened cattleshorn over it. These were widely used by pupils to learn the alphabet and prayers before books were common.

IAMBIC PENTAMETER A type of verse used in plays and sonnets in the 16th and 17th centuries. Each line has ten syllables with five stresses. An “iamb” is a unit with an unstressed syllable followed by a stressed one, such as the words “adopt” and “annoy.” “Pentameter” means measure of five. Shakespeare wrote mostly in this style.

INKWELL A pot for holding ink and into which a quill was dipped for writing

LUTE A stringed musical instrument

MACE A ceremonial staff carried by certain officials, such as a mayor or a monarch. Original maces in the Middle Ages were clubs with spiked heads and were used as weapons.

MERCHANT A businessperson who trades goods or services, especially on the international market

NIB The pointed tip of a quill, which was dipped in ink and used for writing

PALANQUIN A luxurious covered seat or bed, supported by posts and carried on the shoulders of at least four men. Palanquins were used to transport important people, such as royalty, in public.

PATRIOTISM Love for and loyalty to one's country



Wooden gallows

PENDANT A piece of jewelry hung on a chain around the neck that was fashionable during the Elizabethan era

PLAYWRIGHT A writer of stage drama

PLAGUE A contagious and fatal disease that killed millions in England and is thought to be transmitted by rats' fleas

PROTESTANT A branch of Christianity set up in “protest” against Catholicism during the 15th century and following the principles of Reformation leaders such as Luther and Calvin

PURITAN Puritans were extremely strict Protestants who wanted to rid their church of all traces of Roman Catholicism. Puritans led a very simple lifestyle and considered any pleasure or luxury to be bad.

Gallants wore hats, which they swept off in a lady's presence.



A ruffled collar would have been added around the neck.

Doublet with exquisite hand-embroidery



Part of an Elizabethan costume worn by gallant